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Systems and methods for resource-optimized mixed reality using user-centric adaptive object detection

Abstract

System and method for reducing latency and bandwidth usage in reality devices include a reality device and one or more processors. The reality device includes a camera to operably capture a set of consequent frames of views external to a vehicle. The one or more processors are operable to monitor movements of one or more eyes of a user to obtain eye-tracking data using the reality device, identify an area of interest (AoI) in the frame based on the eye-tracking data, AoI history, or driving statistics of the user, crop the frame to obtain a reduced-size frame including the AoI in the frame, and transmit the reduced-size frame to an edge server for performing a task on behalf of the vehicle.

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Background/Summary

(1) This application claims priority to provisional U.S. Application No. 63/592,957, filed Oct. 25, 2023, which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present specification generally relates to mixed reality, augmented reality, and virtual reality and, more specifically, to mixed reality, augmented reality, and virtual reality using in networking.

BACKGROUND

(2) Augmented reality (AR) technologies can be integrated into vehicle applications to enhance user interaction and mobility experiences. Remote AR data processing can release local AR computation usage and leverage cloud resources. Therefore, there is a need for a system and

method for mixed reality (MR) applications that employ user centric adaptive image/frame data transmission to balance the use of server resources for intensive processing tasks while maintaining network performance and cost-effectiveness.

SUMMARY

(3) In one embodiment, a system for reducing latency and bandwidth usage includes a reality device including a camera to operably capture a frame of a view external to a vehicle, and one or more processors. The one or more processors are operable to monitor movements of one or more eyes of a user to obtain eye-tracking data using the reality device, identify an area of interest (AoI) in the frame based on the eye-tracking data, AoI history, or driving statistics of the user, crop the frame to obtain a reduced-size frame including the AoI in the frame, and transmit the reduced-size frame to an edge server for performing a task on behalf of the vehicle.

(4) In another embodiment, a method for reducing latency and bandwidth usage includes monitoring movements of one or more eyes of a user to obtain eye-tracking data using a reality device, identifying an area of interest (AoI) in a frame of a view external to a vehicle based on the eye-tracking data, AoI history, or driving statistics of the user, wherein the frame is captured by the reality device, cropping the frame to obtain a reduced-size frame including the AoI in the frame, and transmitting the reduced-size frame to an edge server for performing a task on behalf of the vehicle.

(5) These and additional features provided by the embodiments of the present disclosure will be more fully understood in view of the following detailed description, in conjunction with the drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The embodiments set forth in the drawings are illustrative and exemplary in nature and not intended to limit the disclosure. The following detailed description of the illustrative embodiments can be understood when read in conjunction with the following drawings, where like structure is indicated with like reference numerals and in which:

(2) FIG. 1 schematically depicts an example system for reducing latency and bandwidth usage in mixed reality (MR) usage of the present disclosure, according to one or more embodiments shown and described herewith;

(3) FIG. 2 schematically depicts example components of reality devices of the present disclosure, according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;

(4) FIG. 3 schematically depicts example components of server of the present disclosure, according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;

(5) FIG. 4A schematically depicts an example system for performing cropped frame transmission in MR usage of the present disclosure, according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein

(6) FIG. 4B schematically depicts a flowchart for performing cropped frame transmission in MR usage of the present disclosure, according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein;

(7) FIG. 5 depicts a sequence diagram for performing cropped frame transmission in MR usage of the present disclosure, according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein; and

(8) FIG. 6 depicts a flowchart for performing cropped frame transmission in MR usage of the present disclosure, according to one or more embodiments shown and described herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) Mixed reality (MR) technology, such as augmented reality (AR) or virtual reality (VR), often relies on a combination of on-device and cloud-based processing for tasks like image classification

and object recognition. The development of MR-integrated autonomous vehicles and AR technologies is revolutionizing mobility and user interaction experiences. Among the applications of AR technologies, real-time object detection is a desirable feature for MR applications in MR-integrated autonomous vehicles. These object detection tasks may involve context-sensitive driving, such as understanding the user's expectations when regularly looking at scenery, wildlife, or landmarks, providing real-time navigation assistance, and adjusting object detection based on the user's behavior and interactions with others in the vehicle.

(10) Object detection tasks can be performed either locally on user devices or remotely on servers. Due to limitations in processing power, memory, and energy efficiency, processing MR data locally on reality devices may not always be feasible or desirable. Instead, server-based processing can manage computationally intensive tasks like object recognition, scene understanding, and spatial mapping. This remote processing leverages powerful cloud resources and advanced machine learning algorithms, allowing for real-time analysis and access to continually updated models and data.

(11) Remote XR-based tasks must balance computational requirements and bandwidth usage. Current methods rely on transmitting full or substantial image frames to remote devices and servers, which is resource-intensive and leads to high bandwidth consumption and latency. These methods do not adapt to network conditions, resulting in delays and lags that degrade the user experience due to resource over-utilization. Further, information and outcomes may be transmitted between user reality devices and remote servers via wireless communication, where network congestion, signal strength, and interference from other devices can cause information latency. Accordingly, there exists a need to reduce latency and bandwidth usage in the MR devices through frame cropping based on a user-centric adaptive object detection.

(12) To address the issues of latency and bandwidth usage, the disclosed system and method transmit cropped frames with selective object detection based on user-centric adaptive object detection for optimal resource utilization. By dynamically adjusting the scope of object detection based on the user's eye and head movements and focusing only on predetermined relevant areas or objects, the disclosed system and method enables selective object detection, creates a user-centric, resource-efficient MR experience, and reduces data transmission to improve the system overall performance. The system for reducing latency and bandwidth usage includes a reality device including a camera to operably capture a frame of a view external to a vehicle. The system may monitor movements of one or more eyes of a user to obtain eye-tracking data using the reality device, identify an area of interest (AoI) in the frame based on the eye-tracking data, AoI history, or driving statistics of the user, crop the frame to obtain a reduced-size frame including the AoI in the frame, and transmit the reduced-size frame to an edge server for performing a task on behalf of the vehicle.

(13) Embodiments of systems and methods disclosed herein include a reality device including a camera and a processor. The reality device may be an AR device, such as an AR headset, a VR device, or a MR device. The camera operably images an environment around a vehicle, such as an automatic vehicle, and captures a set of frames. The processor is operable to monitor a user's eye movement using the MR device, identify AoI in the frame based on eye-tracking data, AoI history, or driving statistics of the user, and crop the frame to obtain a reduced-size frame including the AoI in the frame, and transmit the reduced-size frame to an edge server.

(14) In embodiments, the system may adjust object detection based on the user's behavior during interactions with other passengers in the vehicle. For example, the system can temporarily prioritize object detection in front of the vehicle when the user is turning her head to talk to a passenger. The user may further interact with the environment through the MR device, such as an AR headset, where the user's AoI is identified based on eye-tracking data. The user's experience is enhanced as object detection is performed on the user's AoI, reducing latency and offering a more immersive and responsive mixed-reality experience.

(15) Various embodiments of the methods and systems for reducing latency and bandwidth usage in MR applications through user-centric adaptive object detection are described in more detail herein. Whenever possible, the same reference numerals will be used throughout the drawings to refer to the same or like parts.

(16) As used herein, the singular forms “a,” “an” and “the” include plural referents unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. Thus, for example, reference to “a” component includes aspects having two or more such components unless the context clearly indicates otherwise.

(17) Referring now to Figures, FIG. 1 schematically depicts an example user-centric adaptive object detection system **100**. The user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** includes components, devices, and subsystems based on MR-related and data-transmission-based technologies for information deployments during vehicle driving experiences. The MR technologies provide augmented and virtual reality experiences to one or more users (e.g., drivers and/or passengers) of an ego vehicle **101** to enhance situational awareness and entertainment during driving. The data transmission allows a real-time information flow to deliver information to the users in a timely and effective manner. Particularly, the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may capture an image or a frame **401** of environment **105** surrounding the ego vehicle **101** and transfer the image or the frame **401** to a server **301**, such as an edge server, for task performance via wireless communication **250**. The user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may receive data transmitted from the server **301** and further integrate the received data into the MR function deployments.

(18) The user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may include one or more reality devices **201**. The reality devices **201** are the local devices and components used by a user for the MR experience, such as while driving an autonomous vehicle. In some embodiments, the reality devices **201** may perform any MR-related functions to interact with the user to provide an immersive MR experience, without any assistance of external devices or cloud-based services. In some embodiments, the reality devices **201** may collaborate with external devices and services, such as the wireless communication **250** and the server **301**, to enhance the MR experience for the user when local devices may be insufficient to perform the desirable tasks or provide desirable information.

(19) In some embodiments, the reality devices **201** may include, without limitation, a virtual head unit **120**, a computation offloading module **222**, one or more sensors, such as a vision sensor **208**, an eye-tracking sensor **208a**, and a head-tracking sensor **210**, a rendering device **124**, a sound sensor **212**, or a combination thereof. The eye-tracking sensor **208a** may capture information regarding the user's eyes, such as user eye movements. The vision sensor **208** may operably capture environmental images or videos in consequence of one or more frames **401** of environment **105** around the user and/or the ego vehicle **101**. The reality devices **201** may further include the network interface hardware **206** (e.g., as illustrated in FIG. 2) that can be communicatively coupled to a wireless communication **250** to transmit data to and/or from external computing resources, such as the server **301**.

(20) In some embodiments, the virtual head unit **120** may include, without limitations, the vision sensor **208**, glasses **122**, the eye-tracking sensor **208a**, the head-tracking sensor **210**, and the rendering device **124**. The eye-tracking sensor **208a** may operably track the user's eye movements, such as, without limitation, positions, angles, or pupil sizes of the one or more eyes of the user. The eye-tracking sensor **208a** may enable the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** to understand where the user is looking for gaze-based interaction with virtual objects, adjust the level of operation of the system to improve performance and reduce computational load, and analyze the user's attention and interest. The head-tracking sensors **210** may track the user's head movement. The head-tracking sensor **210** may allow the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** to understand the position and orientation of the user's head in physical space. The rendering devices **124**, such as one or more projectors, may superimpose images or texts onto the user's eyes or an

immersive screen, such as a see-through display or the glasses **122**, to render the images or texts into the real-world view of the user.

(21) In some embodiments, the vision sensor **208** may be operable to acquire image and video data, such as one or more frames **401**, of the environment **105** surrounding the reality devices **201**. The vision sensor **208** may include the eye-tracking sensor **208a** operable to acquire images and video data of the user's eyes. The vision sensor **208** may be, without limitation, an RGB camera, a depth camera, an infrared camera, a wide-angle camera, an infrared laser camera, or a stereoscopic camera. The vision sensor **208** may be equipped, without limitation, on a smartphone, a tablet, a computer, a laptop, the virtual head unit **120**, or on the ego vehicle **101**. In operation, the vision sensor **208** may continuously capture one or more frames **401** of the environment **105** surrounding the reality devices **201** or the ego vehicle **101**.

(22) In some embodiments, the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may include one or more displays. The display may be equipped, without limitation, on the ego vehicle **101**, a touchscreen, a smartphone, a tablet, a computer, a laptop, or the virtual head unit **120**. The captured frames or processed frames marked with detected objects with or without related information may be displayed on the displays.

(23) In some embodiments, the vision sensor **208**, the eye-tracking sensor **208a**, the head-tracking sensor **210**, and the rendering device **124** may be included in the ego vehicle **101**. For example, the vision sensor **208**, the eye-tracking sensor **208a**, the head-tracking sensor **210**, or the rendering device **124** may be mounted on a windshield, a steering wheel, a dashboard, or a rearview mirror of the ego vehicle **101**.

(24) In some embodiments, the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may include an interaction device. The interaction device may provide communication between the user and the virtual world. The interaction device may include a tangible object, such as, without limitations, a marker, a physical model, a sensor, a wearable motion-tracking device, or a smartphone.

(25) In some embodiments, the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may include a sound sensor **212**. The sound sensor **212** may operably determine the volume, pitch, frequency, and/or features of sounds in the ego vehicle **101** or around the virtual head unit **120**. The sound sensor **212** may be embedded in the virtual head unit **120** or inside the ego vehicle **101** to detect and process the sound waves that are produced when the user or a passenger speaks in the ego vehicle **101**. The user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may include a speech processor to convert the sound waves into human language and further recognize the meaning within, such as user commands.

(26) In some embodiments, the computation offloading module **222** may include one or more processors communicatively coupled to other reality devices. The computation offloading module **222** may receive data generated by one or more other reality devices **201**, such as the image or video data generated by the vision sensor **208** and the eye-tracking sensor **208a**, the sound data generated by the sound sensor **212**, and the motion data generated by the head-tracking sensor **210**. The computation offloading module **222** may further inquire and receive information on external hardware and devices, such as the wireless communication **250** and the server **301**. The computation offloading module **222** may determine a real-time area of interest (AoI) **402** (e.g., as illustrated in FIG. 4B) of the user based on the eye-tracking data and the motion data. The computation offloading module **222** may crop the frame **401** to generate reduced-size frame **403** (e.g., as illustrated in FIG. 4B) based on the AoI **402** in the frame **401** and send the frames **401** or the reduced-size frame **403** to the server **301**.

(27) In some embodiments, the computation offloading module **222** may include an artificial intelligence (AI) module including one or more AI algorithms. The AI module may be used to monitor AoI **402** of the user corresponding to each frame. The AI module may include a deep reinforcement learning function. The deep reinforcement learning function may include determining the AoI **402** of the frame **401**, based on eye-tracking data, historical area of interest

data **227** (e.g., as illustrated in FIG. 2), driving statistics of the user, or a combination thereof. The AI algorithms may be trained based on the rewards of correct AoI detection that meets the user's demands, reduced bandwidth, and penalty for incorrect AoI detection and missed object detection. (28) The user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may include one or more processors (e.g., as illustrated in FIG. 2). The processors may be included, without limitation, in a controller (such as a computer, a laptop, a tablet, or a smartphone), the virtual head unit **120**, a server, or a third-party electronic device.

(29) The user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may include the ego vehicles **101**. In embodiments, each of the ego vehicles **101** may be an automobile or any other passenger or non-passenger vehicle such as, for example, a terrestrial, aquatic, and/or airborne vehicle. Each of the ego vehicles **101** may be an autonomous vehicle that navigates its environment with limited human input or without human input. Each of the ego vehicle **101** may drive on a road **115**, where one or more non-ego vehicles **103** may share the road **115** with the ego vehicle **101**. Each of the vehicles **101** and **103** may include actuators for driving the vehicle, such as a motor, an engine, or any other powertrain. The vehicles **101** and **103** may move or appear on various surfaces, such as, without limitation, roads, highways, streets, expressways, bridges, tunnels, parking lots, garages, off-road trails, railroads, or any surfaces where the vehicles may operate.

(30) In embodiments, the vision sensors **208** may continuously capture frames of environment **105** surrounding the user and the ego vehicle **101**, such as a non-ego vehicles **103** near the ego vehicle **101**, objects in the environment **105** surrounding the ego vehicle, such as buildings, traffic lights, places of interests, contextual information, such as weather information, a type of the road on which the ego vehicle **101** is driving, a surface condition of the road **115** on which the ego vehicle **101** is driving, and a degree of traffic on the road **115** on which the ego vehicle **101** is driving. The environmental data may include buildings and constructions near the road **115**, weather conditions (e.g., sunny, rain, snow, or fog), road conditions (e.g., dry, wet, or icy road surfaces), traffic conditions, road infrastructure, obstacles (e.g., non-ego vehicles **103** or pedestrians), lighting conditions, geographical features of the road **115**, and other environmental conditions related to driving on the road **115**.

(31) In embodiments, the reality devices **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101** may send a request for task performance and one or more frames **401** or reduced-size frame **403** (e.g., as illustrated in FIG. 5) to the one or more servers **301**. The reality devices **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101** may include a network interface hardware **206** and communicate with the server **301** via wireless communications **250**. The reality devices **201** and/or ego vehicle **101** may transmit, without limitation, the frame **401** or the reduced-size frame **403**, environmental data, sensory data, real-time driver reaction time, and user driving statistics associated with the user. In some embodiments, the ego vehicle **101** may communicate with the server **301** using a smartphone, a computer, a tablet, or a digital device that requires data processing.

(32) In embodiments, the server **301** may be any device and/or edge server remotely connected to the reality devices **201**. The server **301** may include, without limitation, one or more of cloud servers, smartphones, tablets, telematics servers, fleet management servers, connected car platforms, application servers, Internet of Things (IoTs) servers, or any server with the capability to transmit data with the reality devices **201**. The server **301** may include server network interface hardware **306** and communicate with the reality devices **201**, the ego vehicles **101**, and other servers via wireless communications **250**. The server **301** may include an object detection module **322** operable to analyze uploaded images and video frames to identify any objects of interest within the images and video frames and generate object detection data to send back to the reality devices **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101**.

(33) The wireless communication **250** may connect various components, the reality devices **201**, the ego vehicle **101**, and the server **301** of the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100**, and allow signal transmission between the various components, the reality devices **201**, the ego

vehicles, and/or the server **301** of the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100**. In one embodiment, the wireless communications **250** may include one or more computer networks (e.g., a personal area network, a local area network, or a wide area network), cellular networks, satellite networks, a global positioning system, and combinations thereof. Accordingly, the reality devices **201**, the ego vehicles **101**, and the servers **301** can be communicatively coupled to the wireless communications **250** via a wide area network, a local area network, a personal area network, a cellular network, or a satellite network, etc. Suitable local area networks may include wired Ethernet and/or wireless technologies such as Wi-Fi. Suitable personal area networks may include wireless technologies such as IrDA, Bluetooth®, Wireless USB, Z-Wave, ZigBee, and/or other near-field communication protocols. Suitable cellular networks include, but are not limited to, technologies such as LTE, WiMAX, UMTS, CDMA, and GSM.

(34) FIGS. **2** and **3** schematically depict example components of the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100**. The user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may include the one or more reality devices **201**, the ego vehicle **101**, and/or the server **301**. While FIG. **2** depicts one reality device **201**, more than one reality devices **201** may be included in the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100**.

(35) Referring to FIG. **2**, the reality device **201** may include one or more processors **204**. Each of the one or more processors **204** may be any device capable of executing machine-readable and executable instructions. The instructions may be in the form of a machine-readable instruction set stored in data storage component **207** and/or the memory component **202**. Accordingly, each of the one or more processors **204** may be a controller, an integrated circuit, a microchip, a computer, or any other computing device. The one or more processors **204** are coupled to a communication path **203** that provides signal interconnectivity between various modules of the system. Accordingly, the communication path **203** may communicatively couple any number of processors **204** with one another, and allow the modules coupled to the communication path **203** to operate in a distributed computing environment. Specifically, each of the modules may operate as a node that may send and/or receive data. As used herein, the term “communicatively coupled” means that coupled components are capable of exchanging data signals with one another such as, for example, electrical signals via a conductive medium, electromagnetic signals via air, optical signals via optical waveguides, and the like.

(36) Accordingly, the communication path **203** may be formed from any medium that is capable of transmitting a signal such as, for example, conductive wires, conductive traces, optical waveguides, or the like. In some embodiments, the communication path **203** may facilitate the transmission of wireless signals, such as WiFi, Bluetooth®, Near Field Communication (NFC), and the like. Moreover, the communication path **203** may be formed from a combination of mediums capable of transmitting signals. In one embodiment, the communication path **203** comprises a combination of conductive traces, conductive wires, connectors, and buses that cooperate to permit the transmission of electrical data signals to components such as processors, memories, sensors, input devices, output devices, and communication devices. Accordingly, the communication path **203** may comprise a vehicle bus, such as for example a LIN bus, a CAN bus, a VAN bus, and the like. Additionally, it is noted that the term “signal” means a waveform (e.g., electrical, optical, magnetic, mechanical, or electromagnetic), such as DC, AC, sinusoidal wave, triangular wave, square-wave, vibration, and the like, capable of traveling through a medium.

(37) The one or more memory components **202** may be coupled to the communication path **203**. The one or more memory components **202** may comprise RAM, ROM, flash memories, hard drives, or any device capable of storing machine-readable and executable instructions such that the machine-readable and executable instructions can be accessed by the one or more processors **204**. The machine-readable and executable instructions may comprise one or more logic or algorithms written in any programming language of any generation (e.g., 1GL, 2GL, 3GL, 4GL, or 5GL) such as, for example, machine language that may be directly executed by the processor, or assembly

language, object-oriented programming (OOP), scripting languages, microcode, etc., that may be compiled or assembled into machine-readable and executable instructions and stored on the one or more memory components **202**. Alternatively, the machine-readable and executable instructions may be written in a hardware description language (HDL), such as logic implemented via either a field-programmable gate array (FPGA) configuration or an application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), or their equivalents. Accordingly, the methods described herein may be implemented in any conventional computer programming language, as pre-programmed hardware elements, or as a combination of hardware and software components. The one or more processor **204** along with the one or more memory components **202** may operate as a controller or an electronic control unit (ECU) for the reality devices **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101**.

(38) The one or more memory components **202** may include the computation offloading module **222**, a user command module **232**, and an eye/head tracking module **242**. The data storage component **207** stores historical eye/head tracking data **237**, historical area of interest data **227**, and historical user interaction data **247**. The historical user interaction data **247** may include, without limitations, historical user driving data, historical user attention data, historical user voice command data, and historical user driving data.

(39) The reality devices **201** may include the input/output hardware **205**, such as, without limitation, a monitor, keyboard, mouse, printer, camera, microphone, speaker, and/or other device for receiving, sending, and/or presenting data. The input/output hardware **205** may include the rendering device **124**. The rendering devices **124** is coupled to the communication path **203** and communicatively coupled to the one or more processors **204**. The rendering device **124** may include, without limitations, a projector or a display. In some embodiments, the rendering device **124** may display digital content directly onto physical surfaces, such as the glass **122**. For example, the rendering device may overlay navigation instructions onto the glass **122** or the road **115** while driving or display additional information regarding objects in the environment **105**. In some embodiments, the rendering device **124** may project images directly onto the user's retina to create a blend of virtual and real-world visuals.

(40) The reality device **201** may include network interface hardware **206** for communicatively coupling the reality device **201** to the server **301**. The network interface hardware **206** can be communicatively coupled to the communication path **203** and can be any device capable of transmitting and/or receiving data via a network. Accordingly, the network interface hardware **206** can include a communication transceiver for sending and/or receiving any wired or wireless communication. For example, the network interface hardware **206** may include an antenna, a modem, LAN port, WiFi card, WiMAX card, mobile communications hardware, near-field communication hardware, satellite communication hardware and/or any wired or wireless hardware for communicating with other networks and/or devices. In one embodiment, the network interface hardware **206** includes hardware configured to operate in accordance with the Bluetooth® wireless communication protocol. The network interface hardware **206** of the reality devices **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101** may transmit its data to the server **301** via the wireless communication **250**. For example, the network interface hardware **206** of the reality devices **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101** may transmit original or processed frames **401** and other task related data to the server **301**, and receive processed information, task performance results, and any relevant data, such as, without limitation, vehicle data, image and video data, object detection data, and the like from the server **301**.

(41) In some embodiments, the vision sensor **208** is coupled to the communication path **203** and communicatively coupled to the processor **204**. The reality device **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101** may include one or more vision sensors **208**. The vision sensors **208** may be used for capturing images or videos of the environment **105** around the user and/or the ego vehicles **101**. In some embodiments, the one or more vision sensors **208** may include one or more imaging sensors configured to operate in the visual and/or infrared spectrum to sense visual and/or infrared light.

Additionally, while the particular embodiments described herein are described with respect to hardware for sensing light in the visual and/or infrared spectrum, it is to be understood that other types of sensors are contemplated. For example, the systems described herein could include one or more LIDAR sensors, radar sensors, sonar sensors, or other types of sensors for gathering data that could be integrated into or supplement the data collection described herein. Ranging sensors like radar may be used to obtain rough depth and speed information for the view of the reality devices **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101**. The one or more vision sensors **208** may include a forward-facing camera installed in the reality devices **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101**. The one or more vision sensors **208** may be any device having an array of sensing devices capable of detecting radiation in an ultraviolet wavelength band, a visible light wavelength band, or an infrared wavelength band. The one or more vision sensors **208** may have any resolution. In some embodiments, one or more optical components, such as a mirror, fish-eye lens, or any other type of lens may be optically coupled to the one or more vision sensors **208**. In embodiments described herein, the one or more vision sensors **208** may provide image data to the one or more processors **204** or another component communicatively coupled to the communication path **203**. In some embodiments, the one or more vision sensors **208** may also provide navigation support. That is, data captured by the one or more vision sensors **208** may be used to autonomously or semi-autonomously navigate a vehicle.

(42) In some embodiments, the vision sensors **208** may include the eye-tracking sensor **208a**. The eye-tracking sensor **208a** may be operable to track the movements of the one or more eyes of the user and generate the eye-tracking data. The eye-tracking data may include user focus points, gaze fixations of each corresponding focus point, saccades between gaze fixations, scan paths of gaze fixations and saccades, and pupil dilation. The eye-tracking sensor **208a** may be a remote eye-tracking sensor positioned at a distance to track the user's eye movements without needing physical contact with the user, and/or a head-mounted eye-tracking sensor equipped on the virtual head unit **120** or a place inside the ego vehicle **101** that directly tracks eye movements. The eye-tracking sensor **208a** may be an infrared-based eye-tracker that uses infrared light to detect the reflection from the retina and cornea to calculate the point of gaze. For example, the eye-tracking sensor may include an infrared laser source operable to illuminate the user eyes and an eye camera operable to capture the eye-tracking data. The eye-tracking sensor **208a** may be a video-based eye-tracker that uses high-speed cameras to capture eye movements to determine gaze direction. The eye-tracking sensor **208a** may be an electrooculography that measures the electrical potential around the user's eyes to infer movement and position.

(43) In some embodiments, the head-tracking sensor **210** is coupled to the communication path **203** and communicatively coupled to the processor **204**. The head-tracking sensor **210** may include an inertial sensor, an optical sensor, a magnetic sensor, an acoustic sensor, or a combination thereof. The head-tracking sensor **210** may operably monitor and measure the position and movement of the user's head. For example, in one embodiment, the head-tracking sensor **210** may include accelerometers and/or gyroscopes in the virtual head unit **120** to monitor the user's head movements. In another embodiment, the head-tracking sensor **210** may be a camera attached to the ego vehicle **101** to track the position and movement of the user's head.

(44) In some embodiments, the sound sensor **212** is coupled to the communication path **203** and communicatively coupled to the processor **204**. The sound sensor **212** may be one or more sensors coupled to the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** for determining the volume, pitch, frequency, and/or features of sounds in the ego vehicle **101** or around the virtual head unit **120**. The sound sensor **212** may include a microphone or an array of microphones that may include mechanisms to filter background noise, such as engine sounds or beamforming. The sound sensor **212** may be embedded in the virtual head unit **120** or inside the ego vehicle **101** to detect and process the sound waves that are produced when a person speaks in the vehicle. For example, the sound sensor **212** may be located in the ceiling, dashboard, or center console of the ego vehicle

101. The sound sensor **212** may be connected to one or more microphones picking up the soundwaves. The soundwaves may be then processed by the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** which converts the soundwaves into digital signals.

(45) Referring to FIG. 3, the server **301** includes one or more processors **304**, one or more memory components **302**, data storage component **307**, server network interface hardware **306**, and a local interface **303**. The one or more processors **304** may be a controller, an integrated circuit, a microchip, a computer, or any other computing device. The one or more memory components **302** may comprise RAM, ROM, flash memories, hard drives, or any device capable of storing machine-readable and executable instructions such that the machine-readable and executable instructions can be accessed by the one or more processors **304**. The one or more memory components **302** may include an object detection module **322**. The data storage component **307** may store historical object detection data **327**, historical user preference data **337**, and object information data **347**.

(46) In some embodiments, the object detection module **322** may, after receiving an object detection task request and the frame **401** or the reduced-size frame **403** from the reality devices **201** or the ego vehicle **101**, normalize, resize, and adjust the received selected frames, use one or more object detection models, such as You Only Look Once (YOLO), Single Shot Multibox Detector (SSD), Region-based Convolutional Neural Networks (R-CNN) to generated model outputs, such as, without limitation, bounding boxes (e.g., coordinates of rectangles around detected objects), class labels (e.g., type of the object), and confidence scores for each detected object. In some embodiments, the object detection module **322** may further conduct non-maximum suppression to eliminate redundant overlapping boxes and apply a confidence score threshold to filter out low-confidence detections. The generated detection data, such as [{"Boxes": [coordinate point 1, coordinate point 2, coordinate point 3, coordinate point 4], "Confidence": [a value between 0 and 1], "Classes": "object type"}], for each detected object, may be sent to the reality devices **201**. The object detection and detection data transmission may consider other factors, such as the user's preference and past object detection.

(47) Referring back to FIGS. 2 and 3, each of the reality device modules and the server modules, such as the computation offloading module **222**, the eye/head tracking module **242**, the user command module **232**, and the object detection module **322**, may include one or more machine learning algorithms. The reality device modules and the server modules may be trained and provided with machine-learning capabilities via a neural network as described herein. By way of example, and not as a limitation, the neural network may utilize one or more artificial neural networks (ANNs). In ANNs, connections between nodes may form a directed acyclic graph (DAG). ANNs may include node inputs, one or more hidden activation layers, and node outputs, and may be utilized with activation functions in the one or more hidden activation layers such as a linear function, a step function, logistic (Sigmoid) function, a tanh function, a rectified linear unit (ReLU) function, or combinations thereof. ANNs are trained by applying such activation functions to training data sets to determine an optimized solution from adjustable weights and biases applied to nodes within the hidden activation layers to generate one or more outputs as the optimized solution with a minimized error. In ML applications, new inputs may be provided (such as the generated one or more outputs) to the ANN model as training data to continue to improve accuracy and minimize error of the ANN model. The one or more ANN models may utilize one-to-one, one-to-many, many-to-one, and/or many-to-many (e.g., sequence-to-sequence) sequence modeling. The one or more ANN models may employ a combination of artificial intelligence techniques, such as, but not limited to, Deep Reinforcement Learning (DRL), Random Forest Classifiers, Feature extraction from audio, images, clustering algorithms, or combinations thereof. In some embodiments, a convolutional neural network (CNN) may be utilized. For example, a convolutional neural network (CNN) may be used as an ANN that, in the field of machine learning, for example, is a class of deep, feed-forward ANNs applied for audio analysis of the recordings. CNNs may be shift or space-invariant and utilize shared-weight architecture and translation. Further, each of the various

modules may include a generative artificial intelligence algorithm. The generative artificial intelligence algorithm may include a general adversarial network (GAN) that has two networks, a generator model and a discriminator model. The generative artificial intelligence algorithm may also be based on variation autoencoder (VAE) or transformer-based models.

(48) Referring to FIGS. 4A and 4B, the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** for reducing latency and bandwidth usage is depicted. The user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may include one or more reality devices **201**, including, without limitations, the vision sensor **208** operably capturing a set of consequent frames **401** of views external to the ego vehicle **101**. The eye/head tracking module **242** may determine the AoI **402** of the user. The computation offloading module **222** may generate the reduced-size frame **403** based on the AoI **402** of the frame **401**. The user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may transmit the reduced-size frame **403** to the server **301**, such as an edge server, a central server, a cloud server, or the like, for performing a task on behalf of the ego vehicle **101**.

(49) In some embodiments, in operation, the user may wear the one or more reality devices **201**, such as the virtual head unit **120** while using or driving the ego vehicle **101**. The vision sensor **208** on the virtual head unit **120** or the ego vehicle **101** may continuously capture images and/or image frames **401** of the environment **105** around the user and/or the ego vehicle **101**. The computation offloading module **222** may determine whether to transfer any captured frames **401** to the server **301** for image processing tasks, such as object detection, considering the local computing resources and efficiency, and the remote devices and network resources and efficiency.

(50) In some embodiments, the computation offloading module **222** may crop the frame **401** based on the user's AoI **402**, for example, using eye-tracking data and head-tracking data. The reality devices **201** may collect the eye-tracking data and the head-tracking data using the eye-tracking sensor **208a** and the head-tracking sensor **210**. The vision sensor **208** may work with the eye/head tracking module **242** and the user command module **232** to determine the states of the generated video frames and focus area. The eye/head tracking module **242** may utilize eye-tracking data from the eye-tracking sensor **208a** and head-tracking data from the head-tracking sensor **210** to assess the user's focus area in the current frame and the interest in objects within the current frame. The eye/head tracking module **242** may determine the AoI **402** based on the eye movements, such as, without limitations, positions, angles, or pupil sizes of the one or more eyes of the user. The eye/head tracking module **242** may estimate the level of interest by analyzing eye movement patterns such as, without limitation, user focus points, gaze fixations of each corresponding focus point, saccades between gaze fixations, scan paths of gaze fixations and saccades, pupil dilation fixation, skipping, regression, alongside head orientation, head movements, and head stability.

(51) In some embodiments, the computation offloading module **222** may identify the AoI **402** in the frame based on the user's gaze-based interaction with virtual objects. The gaze-based interaction may include duration and frequency of gaze to the virtual objects. For example, the eye/head tracking module **242** may determine the AoI **402** in the current frame based on first fixation time and duration, number of fixations, number of visits, and total time spent. In some embodiments, the computation offloading module **222** may identify the AoI **402** based on driving statistics of the user. For example, the computation offloading module **222** may collect driving sensory data to determine driving events, such as acceleration, deceleration, break/stop, and the like, and correlate the user eye movement with the driving events to identify the AoI **402** in the frame **401**.

(52) In embodiments, after determining the AoI **402** in the frame **401**, the computation offloading module **222** may crop the frame **401** according to the AoI **402** to generate the reduced-size frame **403**, and further send the reduced-size frame **403** to the server for task performance, such as object detection.

(53) In embodiments, the algorithms in the various modules in determining the reduced-size frame **403** may be pre-trained, tuned, and continuously trained via machine-learning functions within. For example, the computation offloading module **222** may be a deep reinforcement learning-based

(DRL-based) frame selector. The computation offloading module **222** The DRL may use neural networks to approximate the mapping between network states, user states (e.g., AoI **402**), and actions (e.g., uploading selective frames). The DRL agent learns from trial and error by determining AoI **402**, observing the outcomes, and adjusting its policy to maximize the cumulative reward (such as user MR experience) over time.

(54) In embodiments, the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may transmit the reduced-size frame **403** and object detection task request to the server **301** through the wireless communications **250**. The server **301** may feed the object detection module **322** with the task requirement in the objection detection task request and the reduced-size frame **403**. The object detection module **322** may perform the object detection using one or more object detection models, such as, without limitation, You Only Look Once (YOLO), Single Shot Multibox Detector (SSD), Region-based Convolutional Neural Networks (R-CNN) to detect the objects within each reduced-size frame **403**. In some embodiments, the object detection module **322** may personalize the object detection based on the request information, such as the user's preference, and past object detection, such as the historical object detection data **327**, and historical user preference data **337**. In some embodiments, the object detection module **322** may further conduct non-maximum suppression to eliminate redundant overlapping boxes and apply a confidence score threshold to filter out low-confidence detections. The object detection module **322** may generate object outputs **405**, such as, without limitation, bounding boxes **415** (e.g., coordinates of polygons around detected objects), class labels (e.g., type of the object), and confidence scores for each detected object. For example, an object output may include detection data associated with an identified object, such as [{"Boxes": [coordinate point 1, coordinate point 2, coordinate point 3, coordinate point 4], "Confidence": [a value between 0 and 1], "Classes": "object type"}].

(55) In some embodiments, upon object detection, the server **301** may further retrieve object information **425** related to the detected objects from the object information data **347**, other databases, or the Internet. The retrieved object information **425** may be included in the object outputs **405** to be sent to the reality devices **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101**. For example, in one embodiment, the server **301** may recognize the object as a building that may be of interest to the user based on the user reference data. The server **301** may then retrieve relevant data of the building to be included in the object outputs associated with the building. In another embodiment, the server **301** may recognize the object as a vehicle with a plate number. The server **301** may search the plate number from a vehicle database and retrieve public information regarding the driver of the vehicle, such as, whether the driver has any traffic violations, and further to determine whether to include a warning in the object output associated with the vehicle.

(56) In some embodiments, after the server **301** performs the requested object detection tasks, with optional detected objects information search and retrieval, the server **301** may select generated object detection data **407** to send to the one or more reality devices **201**. The selected object detection data **407** may include the bounding boxes, the class labels, the confidence scores, and the retrieved object information associated with the detected objects in the corresponding reduced-size frame **403**. The selected object detection data may exclude the received reduced-size frame **403**, whose file sizes are usually high in volume. The server **301** may then send the object detection data to the reality devices **201** and/or the ego vehicle **101** via the wireless communication **250**.

(57) Still referring to FIGS. **4A** and **4B**, in some embodiments, after receiving the object detection data, the reality devices **201** may superimpose the object detection data onto a real-world view **409** of the user. The object detection data may be rendered onto only the interested objects included in the AoI **402** in the frame **401**. For example, as the AoI **402** includes a truck, the rendering device **124** may render the bounding boxes **415** of the truck and the retrieved object information **425** of the truck onto the glasses **122** to blend the information into the user's real-world view **409** in real time.

(58) In some embodiments, after receiving the object detection data, the ego vehicle **101** may be autonomously driven based on the object detection data. The user-centric adaptive object detection

system **100** may create a real-time map of the environment **105** and implement a path planning algorithm to determine a desirable route or vehicle operation. The user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may further control the steering, throttle, and braking system of the ego vehicle **101** and monitor the ego vehicle **101**

(59) Referring back to FIGS. **1-4B**, in embodiments, the computation offloading module **222** and the eye/head tracking module **242** may include one or more neural networks to train one or more AI algorithms within to determine the AoI **402** in the frame **401**. The neural networks may include an encoder or/and a decoder conjunct with a layer normalization operation or/and an activation function operation. The encoded input data may be normalized and weighted through the activation function before being fed to the hidden layers. The hidden layers may generate a representation of the input data at a bottleneck layer. After delivering neural-network processed data to the final layer of the neural network, a global layer normalization may be conducted to normalize the output, such as predicted driver reaction time. The outputs may be normalized and converted using an activation function for training and verification purposes, as described in detail further below. The activation function may be linear or nonlinear. The activation function may be, without limitation, a Sigmoid function, a Softmax function, a hyperbolic tangent function (Tanh), or a rectified linear unit (ReLU). The neural networks may feed the encoder with historical area of interest data **227** and historical eye/head tracking data **237**. The one or more neural networks may use regression techniques as described herein. The labeled user data may be fed to the neural network to train the computation offloading module **222** and the eye/head tracking module **242** to optimize the frame selection and transmission.

(60) Referring to FIG. **5**, a sequence diagram for performing cropping frame transmission in MR usage is depicted. At block **501**, a user **500** may wear the reality devices **201**, such as the virtual head unit **120**, while driving the ego vehicle **101** and looking around or moving their head in a different direction. At block **503**, the reality devices **201** may use head/eye tracking technology and perform movement tracking by capturing and processing the user's eye-tracking data and head-tracking data. At block **505**, the reality devices **201** may interpret the collected head-tracking data and eye-tracking data to determine where the user is looking and/or what interests the user is looking. At block **507**, the user-centric adaptive object detection system **100** may make off-loading decisions. The system may determine that the user is focusing on a specific area or object, and the reality devices may decide to offload the object detection task to the edge server for that particular area or object. At block **511**, the reality devices **201** may transmit desirable data to the server **301** based on the direction of the user's gaze or area of interest. At block **513**, the server **301** may perform object detection on the specific area or object that the user is focusing on and generate object detection data. At block **515**, the server **301** may send object detection data (e.g., bounding box info) back to the reality devices **201**. At block **517**, the reality devices **201** may render an MR environment with real-time object detection to the user **500**. For example, the reality devices, upon receiving the results from the edge server, may integrate the results into the MR view of the user. The MR view may include adjusted MR output having highlighted detected object or area. In embodiments, the reality devices **201** and the server **301** may perform continuous data exchange during user interaction. While FIG. **5** depicts performing object detection tasks, other tasks may be requested by the ego vehicle **101** and/or the reality devices **201**, and performed by the server **301**.

(61) Referring to FIG. **6**, a flowchart for illustrative steps for the method **600** for reducing latency and bandwidth usage of the present disclosure is depicted. At block **601**, the present method **600** may include monitoring movements of one or more eyes of a user to obtain eye-tracking data using a reality device **201**. At block **602**, the present method **600** may include identifying an AoI **402** in a frame **401** of a view external to the ego vehicle **101** based on the eye-tracking data, AoI history (e.g., historical area of interest **227** stored in data storage component **207** of the reality devices **201** as in FIG. **2**), or driving statistics of the user. The frame **401** may be captured by the reality device **201**. At block **603**, the present method **600** may include cropping the frame **401** to obtain a

reduced-size frame **403** including the AoI **402** in the frame **401**. At block **604**, the present method **600** may include transmitting the reduced-size frame **403** to the server **301**, such as an edge server, for performing a task on behalf of the ego vehicle **101**.

(62) In some embodiments, the user eye movement may include positions, angles, or pupil sizes of the one or more eyes of the user. The reality device **201** may include an eye-tracking sensor **208a** operable to track the movements of the one or more eyes of the user and generate the eye-tracking data. The eye-tracking sensor **208a** may include an infrared laser source operable to illuminate the user eyes and an eye camera operable to capture the eye-tracking data.

(63) In some embodiments, the eye-tracking data may include user focus points, gaze fixations of each corresponding focus point, saccades between gaze fixations, scan paths of gaze fixations and saccades, and pupil dilation. The identification of the AoI **402** in the frame **401** may be based on gaze-based interaction with virtual objects. The gaze-based interaction may include duration and frequency of gaze to the virtual objects.

(64) In some embodiments, the step of identifying the AoI based on driving statistics of the user of the present method **600** may include collecting driving sensory data to determine driving events, and correlating the user eye movement with the driving events to identify the AoI **402** in the frame.

(65) In some embodiments, the present method **600** may further include receiving object detection data from the server **301**. The object detection data may include box cords of detected objects in the frame **401**, confidence of each corresponding box cord, and object information of each detected object. The present method **600** may further include autonomously driving the vehicle based on the object detection data. The present method **600** may further include superimposing the object detection data onto a real-world view.

(66) It is noted that the terms “substantially” and “about” may be utilized herein to represent the inherent degree of uncertainty that may be attributed to any quantitative comparison, value, measurement, or other representation. These terms are also utilized herein to represent the degree by which a quantitative representation may vary from a stated reference without resulting in a change in the basic function of the subject matter at issue.

(67) While particular embodiments have been illustrated and described herein, it should be understood that various other changes and modifications may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the claimed subject matter. Moreover, although various aspects of the claimed subject matter have been described herein, such aspects need not be utilized in combination. It is therefore intended that the appended claims cover all such changes and modifications that are within the scope of the claimed subject matter.

Claims

1. A system for reducing latency and bandwidth usage comprising: a reality device comprising a camera to operably capture a frame of a view external to a vehicle; and one or more processors operable to: monitor movements of one or more eyes of a user to obtain eye-tracking data using the reality device; identify an area of interest (AoI) in the frame based on the eye-tracking data, AoI history, or driving statistics of the user; crop the frame to obtain a reduced-size frame including the AoI in the frame; and transmit the reduced-size frame to an edge server for performing a task on behalf of the vehicle.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the movements of the one or more eyes comprise positions, angles, or pupil sizes of the one or more eyes of the user.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein the reality device further comprises an eye-tracking sensor operable to track the movements of the one or more eyes of the user and generate the eye-tracking data.
4. The system of claim 3, wherein the eye-tracking sensor comprises an infrared laser source operable to illuminate the one or more eyes of the user and an eye camera operable to capture the

eye-tracking data.

5. The system of claim 1, wherein the eye-tracking data comprise user focus points, gaze fixations of each corresponding focus point, saccades between gaze fixations, scan paths of gaze fixations and saccades, and pupil dilation.

6. The system of claim 5, wherein the identification of the AoI in the frame is based on gaze-based interaction with virtual objects, wherein the gaze-based interaction comprises duration and frequency of gaze to the virtual objects.

7. The system of claim 1, wherein identifying the AoI based on driving statistics of the user comprises: collecting driving sensory data to determine driving events; and correlating the movements of the one or more eyes with the driving events to identify the AoI in the frame.

8. The system of claim 1, wherein the one or more processors are operable to further receive object detection data from the edge server, wherein the object detection data comprises box cords of detected objects in the frame, confidence of each corresponding box cord, and object information of each detected object.

9. The system of claim 8, wherein the one or more processors are further operable to autonomously drive the vehicle based on the object detection data.

10. The system of claim 8, wherein the one or more processors are further operable to superimpose the object detection data onto a real-world view.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the object detection data are superimposed onto a vision of the user or a current real-world frame.

12. A method for reducing latency and bandwidth usage comprising: monitoring movements of one or more eyes of a user to obtain eye-tracking data using a reality device; identifying an area of interest (AoI) in a frame of a view external to a vehicle based on the eye-tracking data, AoI history, or driving statistics of the user, wherein the frame is captured by the reality device; cropping the frame to obtain a reduced-size frame including the AoI in the frame; and transmitting the reduced-size frame to an edge server for performing a task on behalf of the vehicle.

13. The method of claim 12, wherein the movements of the one or more eyes comprise positions, angles, or pupil sizes of the one or more eyes of the user.

14. The method of claim 12, wherein the reality device comprises an eye-tracking sensor operable to track the movements of the one or more eyes of the user and generate the eye-tracking data, the eye-tracking sensor comprising an infrared laser source operable to illuminate the one or more eyes of the user and an eye camera operable to capture the eye-tracking data.

15. The method of claim 12, wherein the eye-tracking data comprise user focus points, gaze fixations of each corresponding focus point, saccades between gaze fixations, scan paths of gaze fixations and saccades, and pupil dilation.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein the identification of the AoI in the frame is based on gaze-based interaction with virtual objects, wherein the gaze-based interaction comprises duration and frequency of gaze to the virtual objects.

17. The method of claim 12, wherein identifying the AoI based on driving statistics of the user comprises: collecting driving sensory data to determine driving events; and correlating the movements of the one or more eyes with the driving events to identify the AoI in the frame.

18. The method of claim 12, wherein the method further comprises receiving object detection data from the edge server, wherein the object detection data comprises box cords of detected objects in the frame, confidence of each corresponding box cord, and object information of each detected object.

19. The method of claim 18, wherein the method further comprises autonomously driving the vehicle based on the object detection data.

20. The method of claim 18, wherein the method further comprises superimposing the object detection data onto a real-world view.
